Technical annex: the equations behind Wpt and WLab

This annex states every equation the guide describes in words, with every constant, so the method can be reproduced without the code. It follows the 2015 Wpt and WLab papers (Derhak and Berns), and the companion package implements each equation in Octave, Python and a spreadsheet; section A.8 says where.

Conventions. Spectra are sampled from 380 to 780 nm in 5 nm steps. Wpt depends on the range and interval: the reference coordinates and every result here use this grid, and the base reflectances are interpolated to it (and extrapolated outside their measured range). Color coordinates are column vectors. Angles are in degrees, and hue angles run from 0 to 360. A superscript + is the Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse.

A.1 Sensor responses from spectra

For an observer with sensitivity functions C_1, C_2, C_3 (color-matching functions, cone fundamentals or camera sensor curves), a material with reflectance O and a light with spectral power L:

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c_i = k \sum_{\lambda} C_i(\lambda)\, O(\lambda)\, L(\lambda), \qquad k = \frac{100}{\sum_{\lambda} C_2(\lambda)\, L(\lambda)}
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The constant k makes the second response of a perfect white equal 100, which for XYZ is the usual Y = 100. Any other constant gives the same Wpt, because steps 2 and 4 of the normalization (A.3) rescale the lightness axis and the chromatic plane. The responses of a perfect white, O(λ) = 1, are written c_w.

A.2 CIELAB and ΔE00

CIELAB uses the tristimulus values X, Y, Z of the sample and Xn, Yn, Zn of white under the same light (CIE 15):

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f(q) = \begin{cases} q^{1/3} & q > 0.008856 \\ 7.787\,q + 16/116 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}
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$$L^* = 116\, f(Y/Y_n) - 16, \quad a^* = 500\,[f(X/X_n) - f(Y/Y_n)], \quad b^* = 200\,[f(Y/Y_n) - f(Z/Z_n)]$$

These are the classic CIE constants; WLab′s lightness (A.5) uses the exact 6/29 form, which differs only for the darkest values. ΔE*ab is the straight-line distance in CIELAB. ΔE00 follows CIE 142 as written out by Sharma, Wu and Dalal (2005).

A.3 Wpt normalization

The Wpt normalization for one observing condition is a 3 × 3 matrix A, so that

$$\begin{bmatrix} W \\ p \\ t \end{bmatrix} = A\, c$$

It is built from the responses c_w of white (A.1), the responses c_j of the 40 base samples (j = 1 … 40) and their reference coordinates p_j, t_j (A.4), in four steps.

Step 1: rotate white onto the first axis. With $R^d(\varphi)$ the rotation by φ in the plane of axes d − 1 and d, rotate first in the plane of axes 2 and 3, then in the plane of axes 1 and 2:

$$R = R^{(2)}(\varphi_2)\, R^{(3)}(\varphi_3), \quad \varphi_3 = -\operatorname{atan2}(c_{w,3}, c_{w,2}), \quad \varphi_2 = -\operatorname{atan2}(c'_{w,2}, c'_{w,1})$$

Here $c'_w = R^{(3)}(\varphi_3)\, c_w$. After R, white lies on the first axis.

Step 2: set white to W = 100.

$$M_1 = \operatorname{diag}\!\left(\frac{100}{(R\,c_w)_1},\, 1,\, 1\right) R$$

Step 3: level the lightness. With $(u_j, v_j, z_j) = M_1\, c_j$, fit $u_j \approx \alpha_1 v_j + \alpha_2 z_j + \alpha_0$ by least squares, then shear so the 40 samples of equal Munsell Value share one W:

$$M_2 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -\alpha_1 & -\alpha_2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} M_1$$

Step 4: fit the hue and chroma plane to the reference. With q_j the second and third components of $M_2\, c_j$, collected as the 2 × 40 matrix Q, and P the 2 × 40 matrix of reference (p_j, t_j):

$$F = P\, Q^{+}, \qquad A = \begin{bmatrix} (M_2)_{\text{row }1} \\ F\, (M_2)_{\text{rows }2,3} \end{bmatrix}$$

A is linear and invertible, white always maps to (100, 0, 0), and every spectrally flat gray maps onto the W axis. If the observer is replaced by any invertible linear transform of itself (cone fundamentals in place of color-matching functions, say), A changes to absorb it and Wpt stays the same.

Constant hue for a reflectance family. Write a reflectance as a spectrally flat part a plus a scale b > 0 on a characteristic reflectance O_c, so O(λ) = a + b O_c(λ). Because A is linear and white maps to (100, 0, 0):

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\begin{bmatrix} W \\ p \\ t \end{bmatrix} = a \begin{bmatrix} 100 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + b \begin{bmatrix} W_c \\ p_c \\ t_c \end{bmatrix}, \qquad h = \operatorname{atan2}(t_c, p_c)
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Every member of the family has the same hue h, for every a and b, in every observing condition; h itself depends on the condition. WLab keeps the Wpt hue angle (A.5), so the family also shares one WLab hue. CIELAB applies its cube root to X, Y and Z separately, which breaks this: for one blue family (Munsell 5PB 5/6 with its minimum removed, a from 0 to 0.5, b from 0.3 to 1), the CIELAB hue spreads by 0.7° under D65 and 12.5° under illuminant A, while the Wpt hue is constant to 10^{-12}.

Where the reference coordinates come from. The reference p_j, t_j were fixed once, under the reference condition (CIE 1931 observer, illuminant C), by the original derivation in the Wpt paper. That derivation rounded the 40 samples onto a circle with an ellipse fit, turned the plane so the vivid yellow (Munsell 3.75Y 8/14) lies along +t with the reds on +p, and scaled the yellow to 100 from the W axis. Every condition, the reference included, now uses step 4 against those fixed values.

Practical Wpt (in preparation) uses base reflectances of the user's choosing, with their own Wpt coordinates under the reference condition as targets. Because those samples need not share one lightness, step 3 becomes a least-squares fit of the W row to each sample's own reference W, with white kept at 100; step 4 is unchanged.

A.4 Reference coordinates of the 40 base samples

The base samples are the Munsell Renotation colors at Value 5 and Chroma 6, one per 2.5 hue steps, with reflectances from the Joensuu Munsell glossy spectral database (Kohonen, Parkkinen and Jääskeläinen 2006), corrected to the renotation under illuminant C (Derhak and Berns, Color Imaging Conference 2012). The 40 reflectances themselves are in the companion package (toolbox/wpt_base_munsell40.csv). Their

reference p and t, used in step 4 of A.3, are listed below to four decimals; the companion package carries them to full precision (toolbox/wpt_reference_pt.csv). Under the reference condition all 40 have W = 19.77.

Sample	p	t
2.5R 5/6	26.6958	10.9828
5R 5/6	26.0683	13.9781
7.5R 5/6	24.9609	16.6028
10R 5/6	22.9904	19.6855
2.5YR 5/6	20.1343	21.8139
5YR 5/6	16.4247	23.8841
7.5YR 5/6	12.7969	25.2459
10YR 5/6	7.9935	26.3794
2.5Y 5/6	3.0201	27.0055
5Y 5/6	−1.7814	27.1721
7.5Y 5/6	−6.2742	26.9339
10Y 5/6	−10.1936	26.2080
2.5GY 5/6	−14.5479	24.6226
5GY 5/6	−18.3866	22.4503
7.5GY 5/6	−22.6269	18.6105
10GY 5/6	−24.9461	14.6733
2.5G 5/6	−26.7275	9.3543
5G 5/6	−27.1418	5.5268
7.5G 5/6	−26.9935	2.6844
10G 5/6	−26.4749	−0.2369
2.5BG 5/6	−25.7375	−3.2592
5BG 5/6	−24.4254	−7.6296

Sample	p	t
7.5BG 5/6	−23.2074	−11.4475
10BG 5/6	−20.8623	−16.1647
2.5B 5/6	−18.2867	−19.7727
5B 5/6	−14.6623	−23.0722
7.5B 5/6	−10.7502	−25.2029
10B 5/6	−6.7638	−26.3787
2.5PB 5/6	−2.1544	−27.2297
5PB 5/6	2.4611	−27.1365
7.5PB 5/6	8.2509	−26.2136
10PB 5/6	13.2497	−24.2460
2.5P 5/6	16.4446	−21.1520
5P 5/6	19.2782	−17.7135
7.5P 5/6	22.1595	−13.1390
10P 5/6	24.1808	−8.8070
2.5RP 5/6	25.6162	−4.3832
5RP 5/6	26.6098	0.9937
7.5RP 5/6	27.0272	4.8202
10RP 5/6	26.9635	8.1618

Relation to the 2015 Wpt paper. The reference coordinates above are those of the Wpt toolbox and the companion package, and they are the canonical ones. The matrices published in the Wpt paper (its Table II), and the original Wpt normalization spreadsheet, use a slightly different reference, related to this one by

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p_{2015} = 1.01125\, p, \qquad t_{2015} = t - 0.01331\, p
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Applying this map to the reference coordinates reproduces the published matrices. White, the W axis and the vivid yellow at t = 100 are the same in both, and both sets of 40 samples are equally round (chroma varies by about 4.4%). WLab values computed with

the published matrices differ by at most 0.7 ΔE(WLab), mean 0.2, over 1,600 Munsell samples under D50 and D65. MATs and observer conversions are identical with either reference, because the map cancels between source and destination.

A.5 WLab, forward and inverse

These are the equations of the WLab paper's appendix. Both directions use the same lightness and hue terms, so WLab converts back to Wpt exactly.

Constants. The implementations use the full-precision values; the paper prints them rounded. Over 1,600 Munsell samples (CIE 1931, D65) the rounded values change WLab by at most 0.05, mean 0.01.

Constant	Value used	Published
g_0	0.026742553710937	0.0267
g_1	51.576165618406904	51.5762
g_2	0.458886718750000	0.4589

Wpt to WLab

1. Lightness:

$$v = \begin{cases} (W/100)^{1/3} & W/100 > (6/29)^3 \\ \tfrac{1}{3}\left(\tfrac{29}{6}\right)^2 (W/100) + \tfrac{4}{29} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}, \qquad L_w = 116\,v - 16$$

2. Chroma and hue of Wpt:

$$c_{pt} = \sqrt{p^2 + t^2}, \qquad h = \operatorname{atan2}(t, p) \in [0, 360)$$

3. Lightness dependence of chroma:

$$s = \frac{e^{\,g_0 (L_w - g_1)}}{g_2}, \qquad c_{mod} = \frac{c_{pt}}{s}$$

4. Hue terms:

$$r_1 = \begin{cases} \sin^3(h - 1) & 1 < h < 181 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}, \quad r_2 = \begin{cases} 0.39 \cos^2(h - 14) & 104 < h < 284 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$d_0 = 62\,(r_1 + r_2 + 0.31), \qquad d_1 = 0.36\,(r_1 + r_2 + 0.19)$$

5. Chroma:

$$C_w = d_0 \left[\ln\!\left(\frac{c_{mod}}{80} + d_1\right) - \ln d_1 \right]$$

6. Cartesian form: a_w = C_w cos h, b_w = C_w sin h. WLab is (L_w, a_w, b_w); the hue angle h is unchanged from Wpt.

WLab to Wpt. Take C_w and h from a_w and b_w, compute d_0, d_1 from h and s from L_w as above, then:

$$c_{mod} = 80 \left[e^{\,C_w / d_0 + \ln d_1} - d_1 \right], \qquad c_{pt} = s\, c_{mod}$$

$$v = \frac{L_w + 16}{116}, \qquad W = \begin{cases} 100\, v^3 & v > 6/29 \\ 300 \left(\tfrac{6}{29}\right)^2 \left(v - \tfrac{4}{29}\right) & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

and p = c_pt cos h, t = c_pt sin h.

A.6 ΔE(WLab)

$$\Delta E_{WLab} = \sqrt{(L_{w,1} - L_{w,2})^2 + (a_{w,1} - a_{w,2})^2 + (b_{w,1} - b_{w,2})^2}$$

The two WLab values may come from different observing conditions, since every condition goes through Wpt. ΔE(WLab) is a material color difference; it corresponds to perceived color differences under a reference observing condition, as CIELAB-based formulas do. In the WLab paper's STRESS tests (RIT-DuPont and Alder data, CIE 1964 (10°) observer under D65 and illuminant A) it was not statistically different from ΔE94, ΔE00, DIN99o or CAM02-UCS.

A.7 Material adjustment transforms and observer conversion

MAT. With A_src and A_dst the Wpt normalizations (A.3) of a source and a destination observing condition, the MAT carries responses from one to the other through Wpt:

$$M_{src \rightarrow dst} = A_{dst}^{-1} A_{src}, \qquad c_{dst} \approx M_{src \rightarrow dst}\; c_{src}$$

White maps exactly: M c_w,src = c_w,dst. For other materials the result is a prediction; what is left over is their color inconstancy between the two conditions.

Observer conversion. Applied to the sensitivity functions themselves, at every wavelength, the same matrix gives a new set of functions that respond to materials as the destination observer does:

$$\mathbf{C}'(\lambda) = M_{src \rightarrow dst}\, \mathbf{C}_{src}(\lambda)$$

where **C**(λ) is the column of the three sensitivities at λ. Source and destination share the illuminant here. When the two observers are invertible linear transforms of each other, as cone fundamentals and color-matching functions of the same observer are, M equals that transform and the conversion is exact (to about 10^{-13} in the companion package). Between different observers it is the best fit for typical materials.

For comparison, a CAT. The von Kries-type CATs used in the companion package scale responses in a space S by the ratio of the two whites, with full adaptation:

$$M_{CAT} = S^{-1} \operatorname{diag}\!\left(\frac{S\, c_{w,dst}}{S\, c_{w,src}} \right) S$$

with S the Bradford or CAT02 matrix, or the identity for plain white scaling in XYZ. A CAT models one viewer adapting, so it is not designed to bridge two different observers.

The two matrices, from XYZ:

$$S_{Bradford} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.8951 & 0.2664 & -0.1614 \\ -0.7502 & 1.7135 & 0.0367 \\ 0.0389 & -0.0685 & 1.0296 \end{bmatrix}, \quad S_{CAT02} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.7328 & 0.4296 & -0.1624 \\ -0.7036 & 1.6975 & 0.0061 \\ 0.0030 & 0.0136 & 0.9834 \end{bmatrix}$$

A.8 Where each equation is implemented

Equations	Octave (toolbox/)	Python (wptonramp.py)	Spreadsheet
A.1 Sensor responses	ref2XYZ.m	ref2xyz	inputs are XYZ
A.2 CIELAB, ΔE00	XYZ2Lab.m, deltaE00.m	xyz_to_lab, delta_e00	Calculator: L*, a*, b*, ΔE*ab, ΔE00
A.3 Wpt normalization	getWptStruct.m	wpt_normalization	Matrices sheet (14 conditions)
A.4 Reference p, t	wpt_reference_pt.csv	load_base	—
A.5 WLab	Wpt2WLab.m, WLab2Wpt.m	wpt_to_wlab, wlab_to_wpt	Calculator (forward)
A.6 ΔE(WLab)	ex02, ex06	delta_e_wlab	Calculator: ΔE(WLab)
A.7 MAT, CAT	ex05_mats.m	mat	MAT sheet

The three implementations agree to within 3×10^{-10} on the Wpt matrices and the spreadsheet, and to within 10^{-7} on WLab for 1,600 Munsell samples (the logs are in the package's results folder).